

BABA AMARJEET MARKUNDI
CULTIVATING THE SELF

Even in a festival of eccentricities, Jata Jau Wale Baba Amarjeet Markundi stands apart. The 50-year-old belongs to no Akhara, has no designated tent. He rests in a quiet corner, away from all the structured chaos. His *sadhana* since 2017 is to nurture life on himself, growing a green crop on his head. The living crown dictates every aspect of his routine. He cannot lie down to sleep, instead resting against a tree or wall. He avoids dust and direct sun, ensuring his "children", as he calls them, do not wither. His farming method is precise: a paste of curd sits on the scalp for two days, then black soil is set in place with cloth. On this organic incubator, he plants the seeds—barley, chickpeas, water spinach, rice, wheat, cannabis—and covers it with his hair. "When the crop is ready, I'll distribute it as prasad," he says. This is dharma performed not as isolation but as connection—to living nature.